



PORTFOLIO EDITION

BLUE TEAM INTERNSHIP

Week 9 Task Report

Browser Forensics · LNK File Analysis

Artifact Integration

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Executive Summary

Overview of Week 9 Deliverables

This report documents Week 9 of the Blue Team Internship, covering Days 57 through 63. Where previous weeks established host-based forensics (disk imaging, event logs, prefetch) and network-layer detection, Week 9 extended the investigation into the application layer: what a user did in their browser, and what files they recently accessed on the system.

Browser forensic analysis was performed on the intern's own machine. Microsoft Edge and Mozilla Firefox were confirmed absent from the system, so the investigation scope was correctly narrowed to Google Chrome rather than reporting incomplete data for browsers that do not exist on this host. The Chrome profile was copied to a working folder only after confirming, via Task Manager, that no Chrome process was locking the database files — preserving evidence integrity before any tool touched the data. Browsing history, download history, cookies, saved-data inventory, cache location, and installed extensions were each examined and documented in turn.

LNK file analysis was carried out on the Recent Items folder using LECmd, successfully parsing all 75 collected shortcut files with zero errors. The resulting dataset was filtered for removable-media and network-share activity, and a full file-access timeline was constructed by sorting on the target-accessed timestamp. Day 63 closed the week by manually cross-referencing the browser timeline against the LNK access timeline to look for corroborating activity across the two artefact sources.

Task Block	Status	Notes
Days 57-59 — Browser Forensics	Complete	Chrome-only scope confirmed; Edge/Firefox not present on host
Days 60-62 — LNK File Analysis	Complete	75/75 LNK files parsed with LECmd, zero errors
Day 63 — Artefact Integration	Complete	Manual cross-reference of browser and LNK timelines

As with previous weeks, this report documents troubleshooting encountered along the way — most notably an initial BrowsingHistoryView configuration issue where the tool returned zero results until the "Specified Profile" source mode and the copied profile path were set correctly — rather than presenting the week as friction-free.

Week 9 Objectives

Days 57-63

Weeks 7 and 8 established host-based forensic technique: disk imaging, event log analysis, prefetch, and deleted file artefacts. Week 9 extended that picture into two further artefact categories that reveal what a user was doing at the application layer: browser activity and recent file access, closing with an exercise integrating this week's findings with the previous two weeks' work.

Learning Outcomes Targeted

Locate and extract browser forensic artefacts across installed browsers, and correctly document when a browser is absent from a system rather than assuming its presence. Explain why clearing history through a browser's own interface does not reliably destroy forensic evidence. Parse LNK files to reconstruct file access history and identify connected devices or network shares from embedded metadata. Combine artefact data across multiple sources into a single, timestamp-normalised timeline, and reason about why timestamps from different tools can legitimately disagree.

SCOPE NOTE

This report follows the three-block structure specified in the Week 9 task brief: Days 57-59 (browser forensics), Days 60-62 (LNK file analysis), and Day 63 (Phase Two artefact integration). Each section documents what was done, what was observed, what was concluded, and any troubleshooting undertaken along the way.

Days 57-59 — Browser Forensics (Google Chrome)

Concepts: SQLite artefacts · evidence integrity · profile locations

Objective

Locate the forensic artefact files for the browsers actually installed on this machine, preserve a forensically sound copy of the Chrome profile before analysis, and extract and document browsing history, downloads, cookies, saved autofill/password data, cache, and extensions.

Browser Inventory

A check of installed applications and the standard install paths confirmed that **Microsoft Edge and Mozilla Firefox are not installed** on this machine. This is documented explicitly as a finding rather than assumed: %localappdata%\Microsoft\Edge does not exist, and no Firefox profile directory was found under %appdata%\Mozilla\Firefox\Profiles. The browser forensics scope for this machine was therefore narrowed to Google Chrome, located at:

```
%localappdata%\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default
```

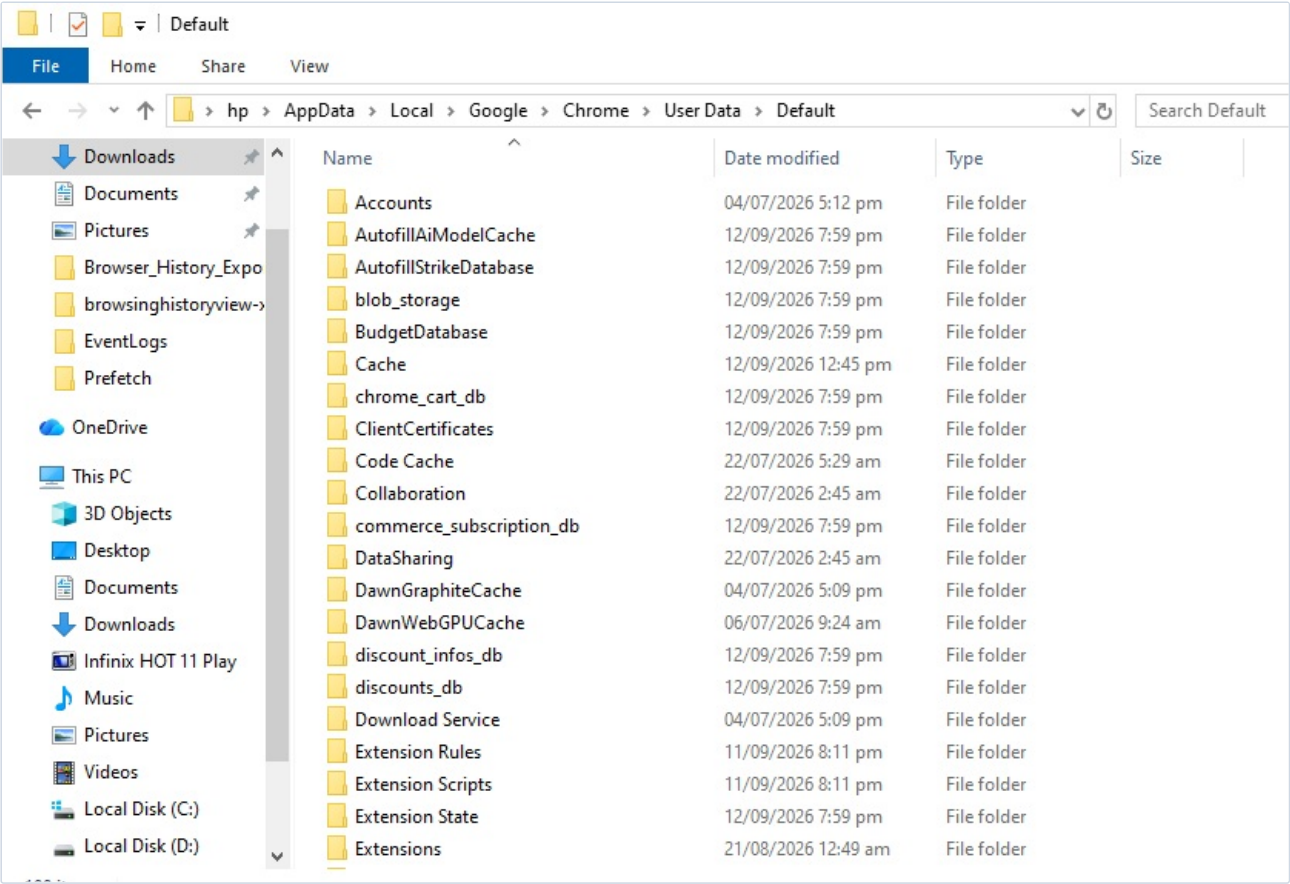


Figure 3.1 — Chrome profile directory confirmed at AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default, containing the forensic artefact files (History, Cookies, Web Data, etc.).

Evidence Preservation

Before any extraction, all Chrome windows were closed and Task Manager was checked to confirm no chrome.exe background process remained running — Chrome is known to hold its SQLite database files open even after the visible window is closed, which can corrupt a forensic tool's read of the file.

Task Manager							
File Options View							
Processes Performance App history Startup Users Details Services							
Name	Status	54% CPU	42% Memory	0% Disk	0% Network	Power usage	Power usage t...
Apps (9)							
> Microsoft Edge (5)		0.8%	58.7 MB	0.1 MB/s	0.1 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Microsoft Store (3)		0%	14.1 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Photos (2)		0.2%	30.9 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Snipping Tool		0.4%	11.0 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Task Manager		7.8%	21.4 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Moderate	Very low
> VirtualBox Manager		0%	8.3 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> VirtualBox Virtual Machine		7.5%	64.7 MB	0.1 MB/s	0.1 Mbps	Low	Very low
> Windows Explorer (2)		3.4%	78.4 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Low	Very low
> XLSX Spreadsheet (2)		0%	13.5 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
Background processes (81)							
> 64-bit Synaptics Pointing Enhanc...		0%	0.2 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Advanced SystemCare Service (...)		0%	4.3 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Advanced SystemCare Tray (32 ...)		0%	3.3 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> AMD External Events Client Mo...		0%	0.6 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> AMD External Events Service M...		0%	0.1 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Antimalware Core Service		0%	2.5 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low
> Antimalware Service Executable		15.5%	165.6 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	High	Low
> Application Frame Host		0%	3.6 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps	Very low	Very low

Figure 3.2 — Task Manager process list confirming no Chrome process remains active before evidence copy.

With Chrome confirmed closed, the entire Default profile folder was copied to a working evidence folder (Downloads\ChromeCopy) so that all subsequent analysis was performed against a static copy rather than the live profile.

ChromeCopy			
Home Share View			
This PC > Downloads > ChromeCopy			
Name	Date modified	Type	Size
Accounts	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
AutofillAiModelCache	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
AutofillStrikeDatabase	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
blob_storage	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
BudgetDatabase	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Cache	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
chrome_cart_db	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
ClientCertificates	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Code Cache	12/09/2026 9:24 pm	File folder	
Collaboration	12/09/2026 9:24 pm	File folder	
commerce_subscription_db	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
DataSharing	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
DawnGraphiteCache	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
DawnWebGPUCache	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
discount_infos_db	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
discounts_db	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Download Service	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Extension Rules	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Extension Scripts	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Extension State	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	
Extensions	12/09/2026 9:22 pm	File folder	

Figure 3.3 — ChromeCopy working folder populated with the full Chrome profile contents (Cache, Extensions, History, and related SQLite databases).

Browsing History

BrowsingHistoryView (NirSoft) was pointed at the copied profile — using the tool's "Specified Profile" source mode against the ChromeCopy folder — to extract the complete browsing history rather than reading the live, potentially-locked database. The exported dataset was filtered to Chrome entries and reviewed for visit count, visit type, and duration per entry.

File

FileHomeInsertPage LayoutFormulasDataReviewView

Sort A to ZSort Z to AFilterClearReapplyData ValidationGroupUngroupSubtotalShow DetailHide Detail

Sort & FilterData ToolsOutline

ExplorerChrome_Edge_History.csv

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Title	Visit Time	Visit Count	Visited From	Visit Type	Visit Duration	Web Browser	User Profile	Browser Extension	URL Length	Typed Count	History File
2		3/7/2026 9:15	0		Link		Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
4		3/7/2026 9:15	0		Form Sub	0:00:03	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
5		3/7/2026 9:14	0		Link	0:01:09	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
6		3/7/2026 9:13	0		Link	0:00:22	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
7		3/7/2026 9:13	0		Link	0:00:07	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
9		3/7/2026 9:13	0		Form Sub	0:00:05	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
10		3/7/2026 9:12	0		Link	0:01:11	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
11		3/7/2026 9:12	0		Link	0:00:05	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
12		3/7/2026 9:11	0		Link	0:00:22	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
13		3/7/2026 9:11	0		Link	0:00:31	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
14		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:37	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
15		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:04	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
19		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:08	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
20		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:02	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
21		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:02	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
22		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Link	0:00:01	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
23		3/7/2026 9:10	0		Reload	0:00:06	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
25		3/7/2026 8:16	0		Link	0:26:12	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
26		3/7/2026 8:16	0		Link	0:00:04	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
28		3/7/2026 8:15	0		Form Sub	0:00:02	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
29		3/7/2026 8:15	0		Link	0:00:47	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
30		3/7/2026 8:14	0		Link	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
31		3/7/2026 8:14	0		Link	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
33		3/7/2026 8:14	0		Form Sub	0:00:03	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
34		3/7/2026 8:13	0		Link	0:01:01	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
35		3/7/2026 8:13	0		Link	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
36		3/7/2026 8:12	0		Link	0:00:42	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History

Figure 3.4 — Chrome browsing history extracted via BrowsingHistoryView, showing Visit Time, Visit Type, Visit Duration, and source History File path for each record.

Download History

Chrome's native download history (chrome://downloads) was reviewed to document each downloaded file's name, source, and status. The list was dominated by coursework materials (task briefs, a WinRAR installer, and reference PDFs), consistent with expected use of the machine for internship work.

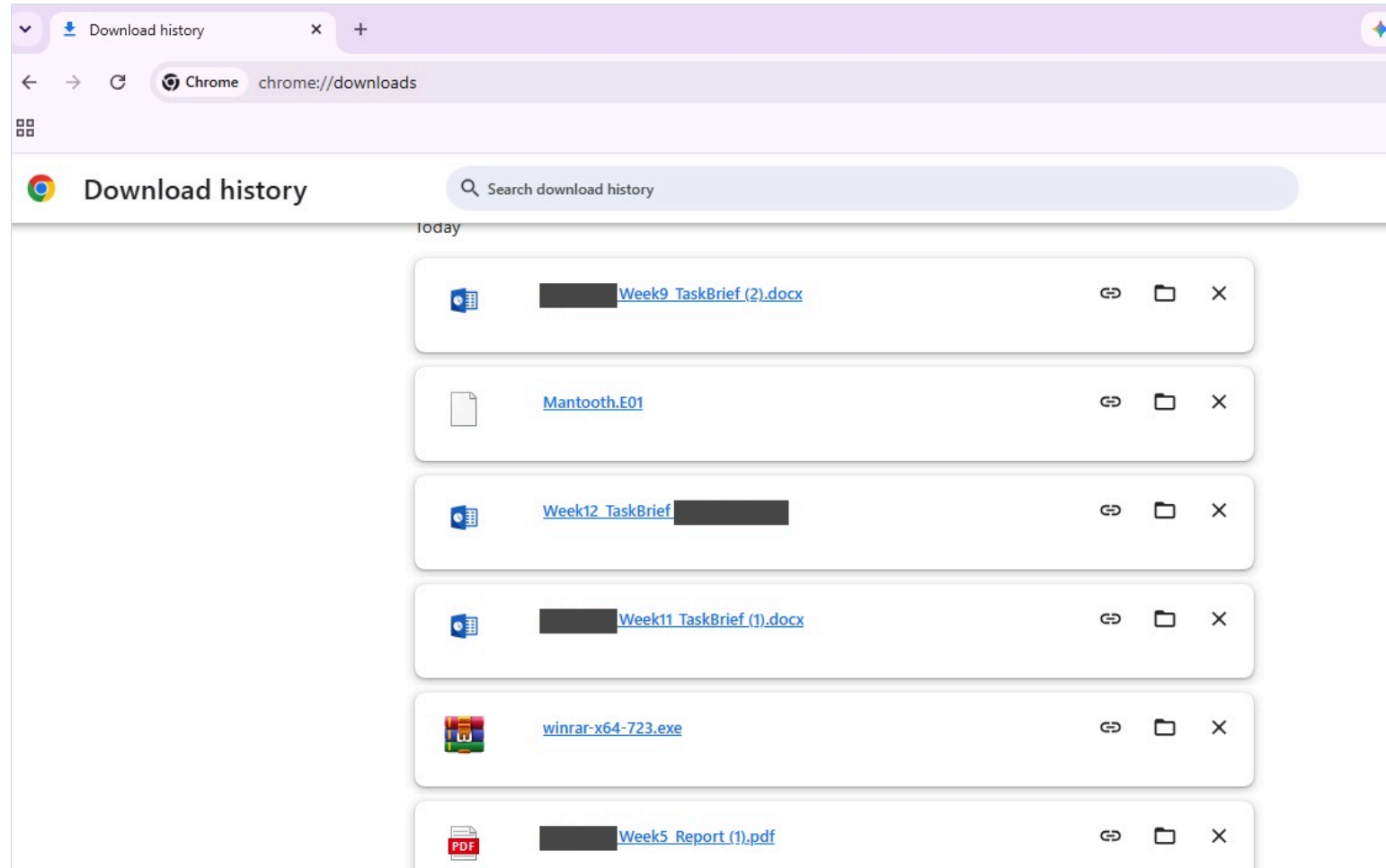


Figure 3.5 — Chrome download history showing recent downloads; entries are consistent with routine coursework activity and contain no unusual or unexpected download sources.

Cache

The Chrome cache directory was located directly under the profile folder for completeness of the artefact inventory, ahead of running a dedicated cache-parsing tool (ChromeCacheView) for item-level analysis.

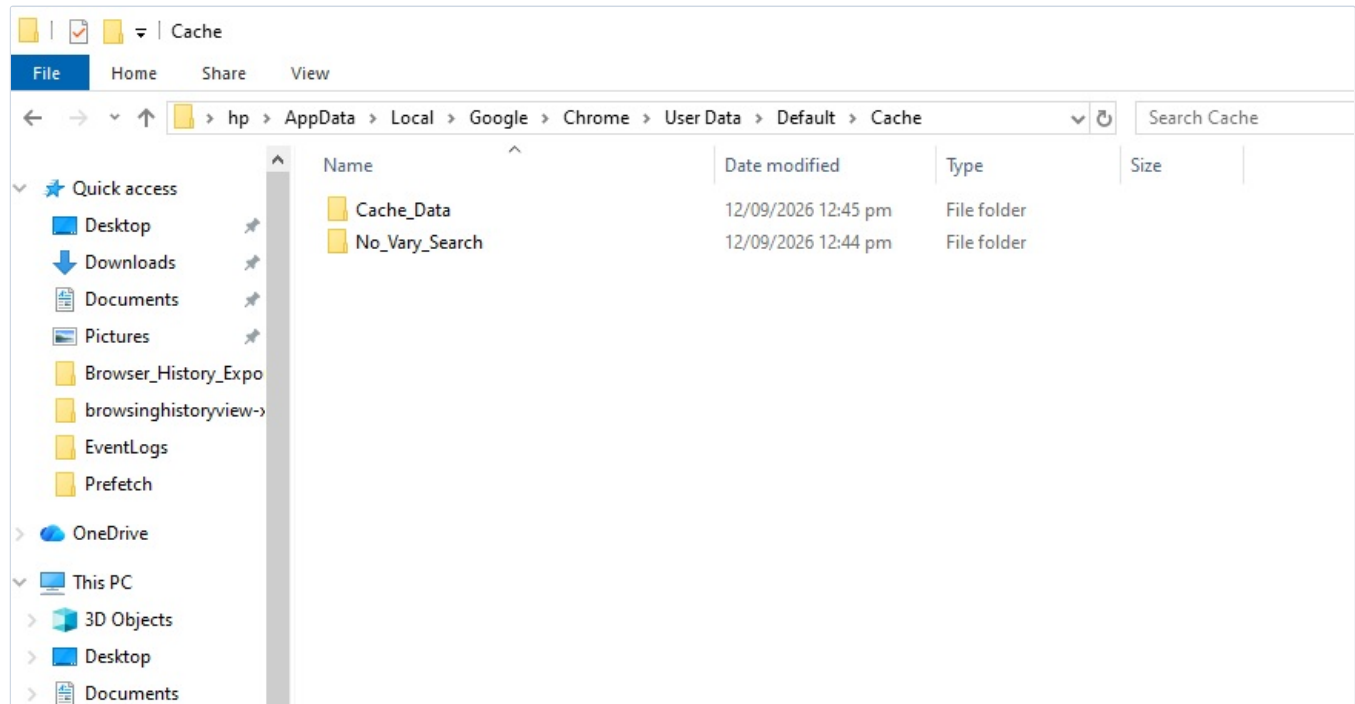


Figure 3.6 — Chrome Cache directory located at ...\\Google\\Chrome\\User Data\\Default\\Cache, containing Cache_Data and No_Vary_Search subfolders.

Cookies & Session Data

Chrome's "All Sites" storage view was used to enumerate domains that have set cookies. The domain list was dominated by common, low-risk services (Google, Microsoft, Bing) with a small number of entries from any . run, a malware-analysis sandbox — consistent with, and expected from, cybersecurity training activity on this machine rather than indicating anything anomalous.

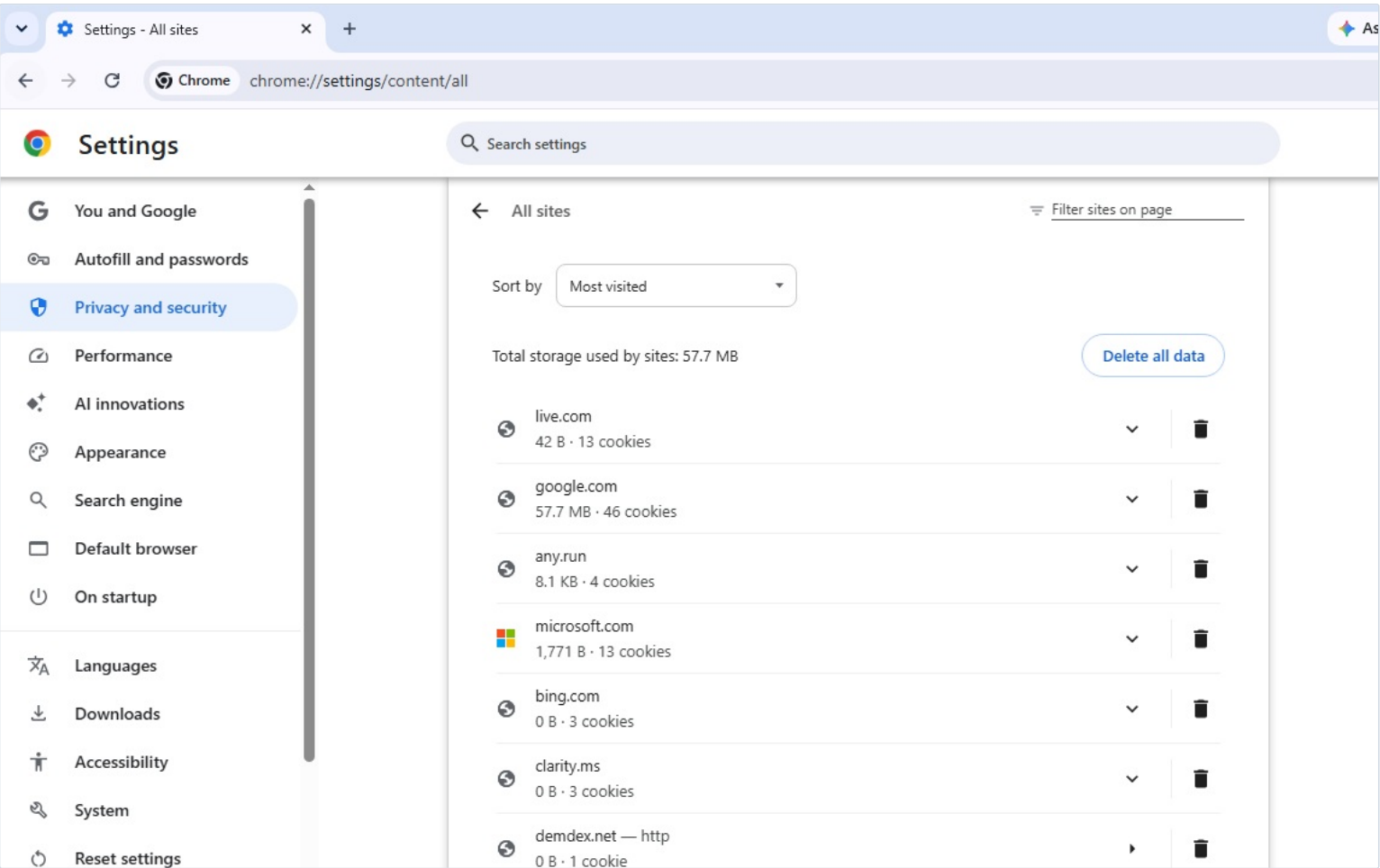


Figure 3.7 — Chrome "All Sites" storage view listing domains with stored cookies, sorted by most visited, with no evidence of tracking from high-risk or unexpected domains.

Autofill & Saved Data Inventory

Chrome's Password Manager and Autofill settings page was reviewed to inventory categories of saved data without exposing raw credential values. A single non-Google account entry visible on this page was manually redacted prior to capture, in line with the operational-security requirement for all report screenshots.

SAVED DATA INVENTORY
Saved Passwords: **Yes (6)** | Passkeys: present (count not exposed in this view) | Payment Methods: category present, no items counted in this view | Autofill / Contact Info: **Yes (1 address)**

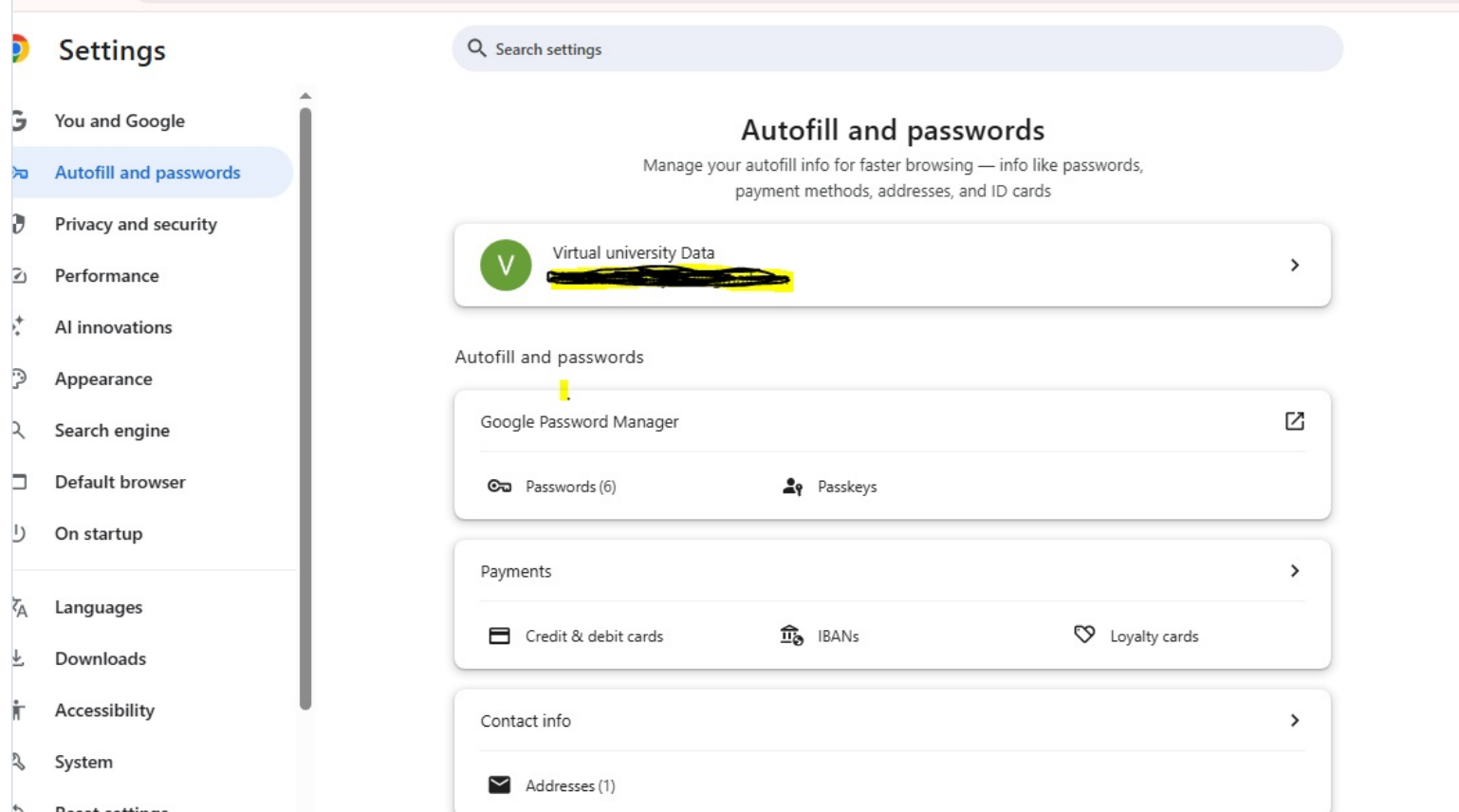


Figure 3.8 — Chrome Autofill and Passwords settings page; a personal account identifier at the top of the page was manually redacted before capture.

Extensions

The Chrome extensions page (<chrome://extensions/>) was reviewed for installed extensions and their requested permissions — the most forensically significant field, since a browser extension with permission to read or modify all site data is a plausible data-exfiltration vector regardless of other controls in place.

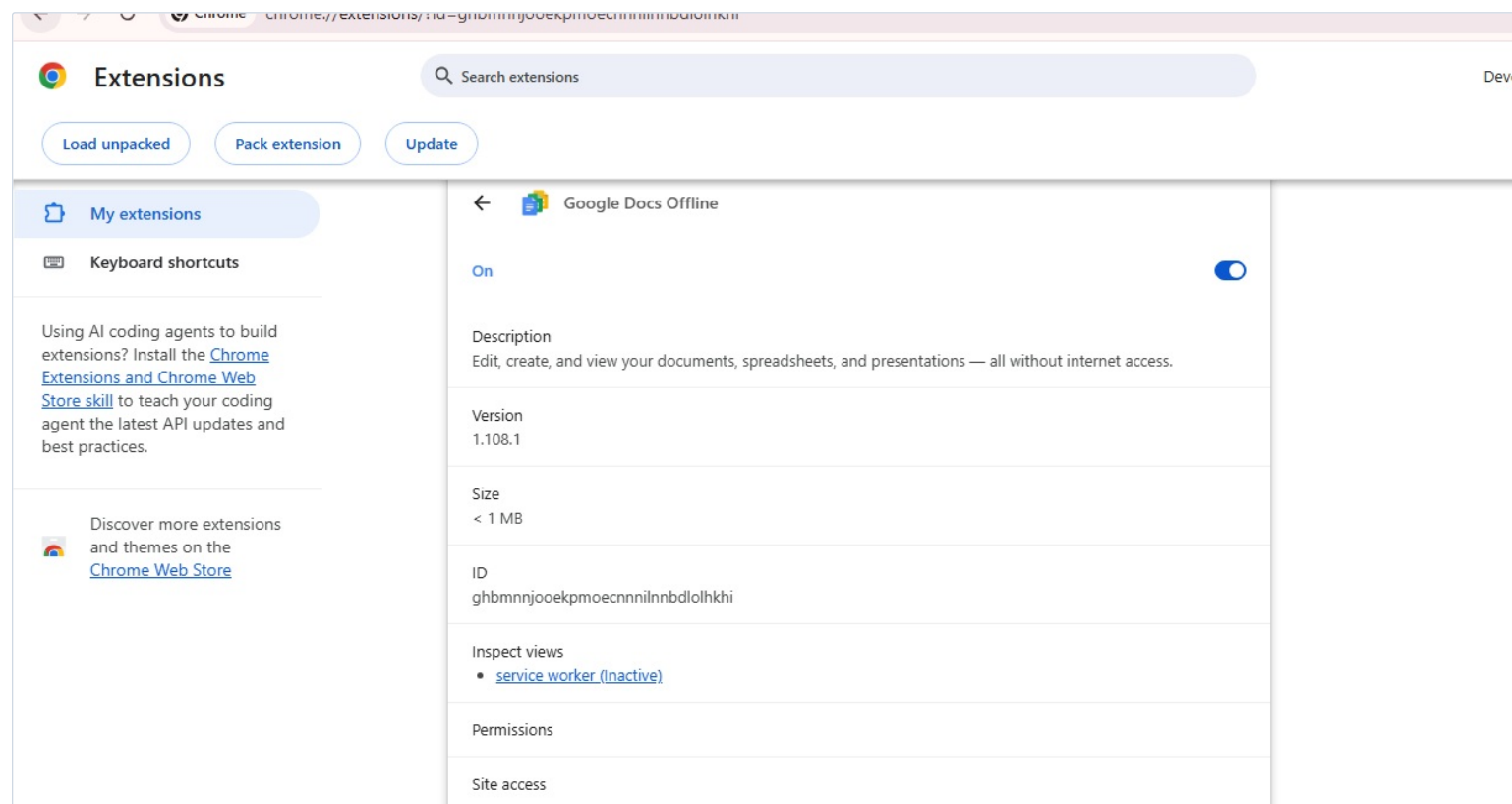


Figure 3.9 — Only one extension installed: Google Docs Offline, a first-party Google extension bundled with Chrome for offline document editing.

EXTENSION RISK ASSESSMENT

Only one extension is installed — Google Docs Offline, a first-party Google extension. No third-party extensions were found, and therefore no disproportionate or high-risk permission grants were identified in this category. This is a clean, low-risk finding.

Unified Browsing Timeline

The Chrome history export was filtered to remove non-Chrome artefacts and sorted chronologically by visit time to produce a single browsing timeline for the machine. URL and Title columns are withheld from this figure in accordance with the personal-privacy redaction requirement in the task brief.

File

File Home Insert Page Layout Formulas Data Review View

Gridlines Zoom Zoom Out Zoom In 100% Freeze Panes Window

Explorer Chrome_Edge_History.csv

	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	1/6/2026 4:25	0		Link		Chrome	hp	Profile 1	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 1\History
2	1/6/2026 4:25	0		Link	0:00:07	Chrome	hp	Profile 1	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 1\History
4	1/6/2026 4:25	0		Link		Chrome	hp	Profile 1	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 1\History
5	1/7/2026 0:06	26		Auto Book	0:00:36	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	72	6	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
6	1/7/2026 0:06	33		Link	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	25	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
7	1/7/2026 0:06	21		Link		Chrome	hp	Profile 4	59	1	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
9	1/7/2026 0:30	0		Generated	0:00:16	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
10	1/7/2026 0:31	0		Link	0:14:42	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
11	1/7/2026 1:39	0		Reload	0:00:08	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
12	1/7/2026 1:39	0		Link	0:00:10	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
13	1/7/2026 1:39	0		Link	0:00:06	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
14	1/7/2026 1:39	0		Link	0:10:35	Chrome	hp	Profile 4	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Profile 4\History
15	1/7/2026 1:58	0		Auto Book	0:01:56	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
19	1/7/2026 2:00	12		Link	0:00:20	Chrome	hp	Default	50	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
20	1/7/2026 2:00	100		Auto Book	0:00:41	Chrome	hp	Default	19	28	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
21	1/7/2026 2:00	4		Link	0:00:17	Chrome	hp	Default	73	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
22	1/7/2026 2:01	140		Link	0:00:08	Chrome	hp	Default	63	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
23	1/7/2026 2:01	0		Link	0:00:07	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
25	1/7/2026 2:01	0		Link	0:00:58	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
26	1/7/2026 2:02	0		Link	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
28	1/7/2026 2:02	0		Link	0:01:19	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
29	1/7/2026 2:03	105		Typed URI	0:00:09	Chrome	hp	Default	18	27	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
30	1/7/2026 2:03	122		Link	0:07:35	Chrome	hp	Default	21	1	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
31	1/7/2026 2:04	0		Link	0:00:05	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
33	1/7/2026 2:04	0		Link	0:02:27	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
34	1/7/2026 2:06	0		Form Sub	0:00:05	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
35	1/7/2026 2:06	140		Link	0:00:10	Chrome	hp	Default	63	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History
36	1/7/2026 2:06	0		Link	0:01:41	Chrome	hp	Default	0	0	C:\Users\hp\AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default\History

Chrome_Edge_History

Figure 3.10 — Unified Chrome browsing timeline sorted chronologically by Visit Time; URL and Title columns withheld from this figure to protect personal browsing content.

Additional Findings (Supplementary)

Outside the core Week 9 scope, the Recycle Bin and Thumbcache were briefly examined as supplementary artefacts. These are not required Week 9 deliverables but are documented here for completeness.

```

Administrator: Command Prompt
12/09/2026 05:16 am 118,655 $RG3KCHS.PNG
12/09/2026 02:50 am 32,195 $RG77JOA.PNG
12/09/2026 01:53 am 51,177 $RGNTCJU.PNG
12/09/2026 12:49 am 60,882 $RHJQGXS.PNG
12/09/2026 03:23 am 10,397 $RHJS3YM.PNG
12/09/2026 04:41 am 48,770 $RHYOFJ9.PNG
12/09/2026 04:33 am 31,157 $RHZC2Q7.PNG
12/09/2026 03:27 am 131,826 $RJUOWEW.PNG
12/09/2026 12:53 am 33,204 $RK1Q97V.PNG
12/09/2026 03:17 am 97,505 $RKRIWTI.PNG
22/07/2026 08:19 pm 162,732 $RM7LOQF.webp
12/09/2026 04:14 am 52,609 $RMCCQEO.PNG
12/09/2026 02:52 am 15,205 $RMGIVUU.PNG
12/09/2026 05:03 am 21,085 $RMHYBDH.PNG
12/09/2026 01:40 pm 94,345 $RMQ477I.PNG
22/07/2026 08:19 pm 179,340 $ROFFQ6I.webp
12/09/2026 12:28 am 55,689 $RONEZHS.PNG
12/09/2026 03:18 am 30,372 $ROWS3EA.PNG
12/09/2026 03:41 am 106,711 $RPRZZJ5.PNG
12/09/2026 12:22 am 117,826 $RQ440GV.PNG
12/09/2026 01:30 am 12,840 $RQBEM3R.PNG
12/09/2026 01:05 pm 9,816 $RQSOU1J.PNG
23/07/2026 05:23 pm 106,009 $RQWSJOU.pdf
12/09/2026 01:45 pm 71,194 $RQWUL5K.PNG
12/09/2026 02:56 am 26,130 $RRDR6TY.PNG
12/09/2026 04:03 am 57,931 $RRZX5M8.PNG
12/09/2026 01:39 pm 102,620 $RSFGBVL.PNG
12/09/2026 01:32 pm 91,906 $RT10R2Z.PNG
12/09/2026 12:45 am 15,796 $RTRUCQR.PNG
12/09/2026 01:14 am 44,343 $RUNFB6E.PNG
12/09/2026 01:17 am 23,797 $RUYUT14.PNG
23/07/2026 05:22 pm 4,792 $RVBFVBU.md
12/09/2026 05:06 am 21,085 $RXN9CKT.PNG
12/09/2026 01:35 pm 93,201 $RY3RQCO.PNG
12/09/2026 01:11 am 25,468 $RYD3BD3.PNG
12/09/2026 04:35 am 11,641 $RYUUX7Q.PNG
12/09/2026 04:16 am 142,124 $RYZ7CA9.PNG
12/09/2026 01:08 pm 177,675 $RZMQBTK.PNG
12/09/2026 05:09 am 196,653 $RZZONCE.PNG
04/07/2026 06:23 am 129 desktop.ini
149 File(s) 5,054,050 bytes
2 Dir(s) 11,462,238,208 bytes free

C:\$Recycle.Bin\S-1-5-21-1718504809-3388621995-1181709251-1001>

```

Figure 3.11 (supplementary) — Recycle Bin \$R (content) files listed via command line, confirming deleted-file remnants remain recoverable after deletion.

```

Waiting 30 seconds... Retrying...
New File 1.0 m thumbcache
2026/09/12 14:06:59 ERROR 0 (0x00000000) Copying File C:\U
The operation completed successfully.
Waiting 30 seconds...^C
C:\Windows\system32>dir C:\Forensics\Thumbcache
Volume in drive C has no label.
Volume Serial Number is D265-6BD6

Directory of C:\Forensics\Thumbcache

12/09/2026 02:04 pm <DIR> .
12/09/2026 02:04 pm <DIR> ..
21/08/2026 03:04 am 2,097,152 thumbcache_1280.db
1 File(s) 2,097,152 bytes
2 Dir(s) 11,495,358,464 bytes free

C:\Windows\system32>

```

Figure 3.12 (supplementary) — Thumbcache database copied to a working forensics folder for potential thumbnail-recovery analysis.

Understanding Verification

Why does clearing history through the browser interface not reliably destroy forensic evidence?

Browsers typically mark history records as deleted within the SQLite database without overwriting the underlying data on disk, meaning the records remain recoverable using database forensics techniques even after the user believes the history is gone. Cache files may be overwritten as the cache fills, but the history and download databases are comparatively persistent.

Why was it necessary to confirm Edge and Firefox were absent, rather than simply skipping them?

A forensic report that silently omits a browser category could be misread as an incomplete investigation rather than an accurate one. Explicitly confirming and documenting the absence of a browser turns a gap in the data into a stated, verified finding — the same standard applied later to the absence of USB and network-share activity in the LNK analysis.

DELIVERABLES SUBMITTED — DAYS 57-59

Chrome profile location and evidence-copy screenshots · Chrome browsing history export (CSV) · downloads history · cache folder location · cookie domain summary · autofill/saved-data inventory · extensions and permissions review · unified, chronologically sorted browsing timeline

Days 60-62 — LNK File Analysis

Concepts: shell link metadata · volume serial numbers · file access reconstruction

Objective

Collect LNK (shortcut) files from the Recent Items folder, parse them with LECmd to recover embedded metadata, and use the resulting dataset to reconstruct a file-access timeline and identify any removable-media or network-share activity.

Collection

LNK files were located in the Recent Items folder at %AppData%\Microsoft\Windows\Recent and copied to a working folder before parsing, so that the source directory was not modified during analysis.

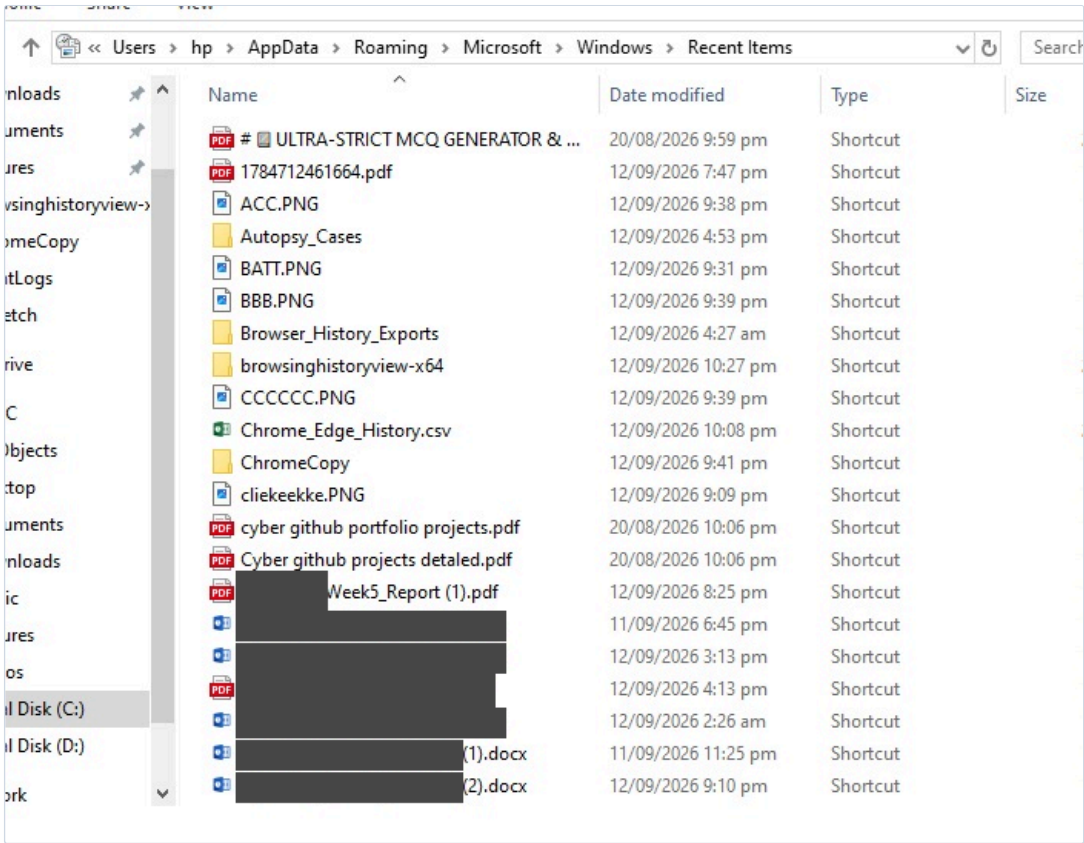


Figure 4.1 — Recent Items folder listing LNK (Shortcut-type) files pointing to recently accessed documents and course materials.

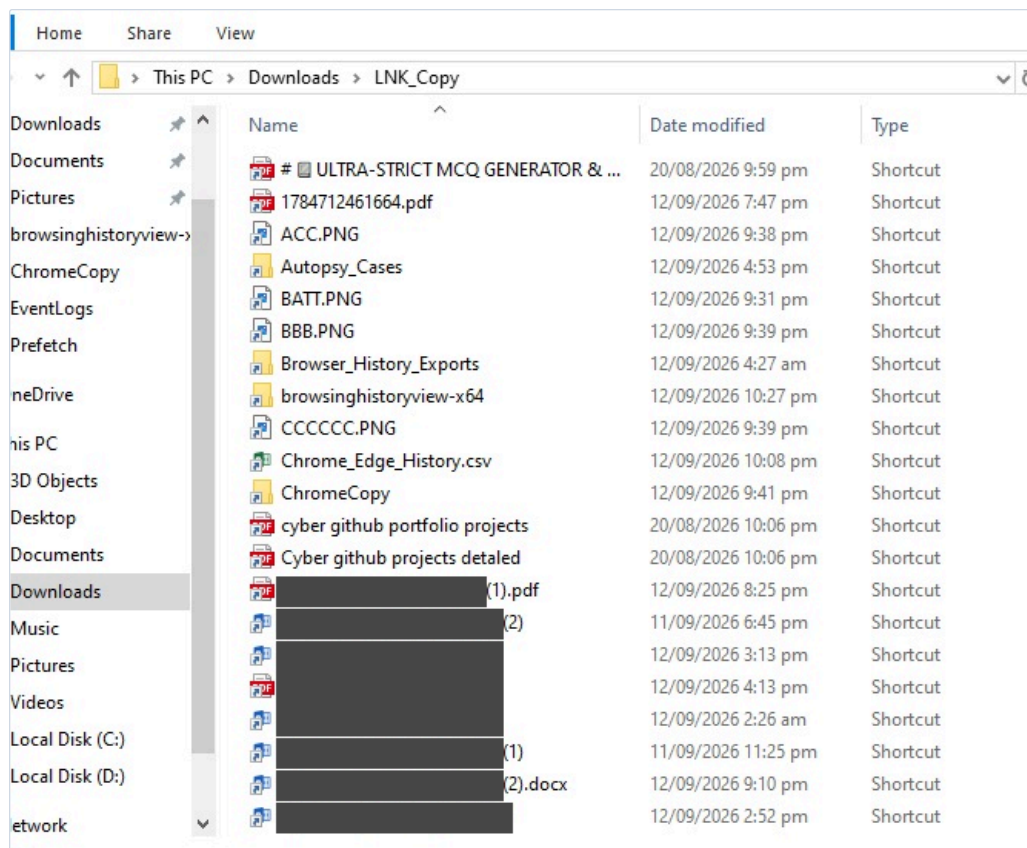


Figure 4.2 — All LNK files copied to a dedicated working folder (LNK_Copy) ahead of parsing.

Parsing with LECmd

LECmd (Eric Zimmerman Tools) was run against the collected LNK files with CSV output enabled:

```
LECmd.exe -d "C:\Users\hp\Downloads\LNK_Copy" --csv "C:\Users\hp\Downloads" --csvf LNK_Output.csv
```

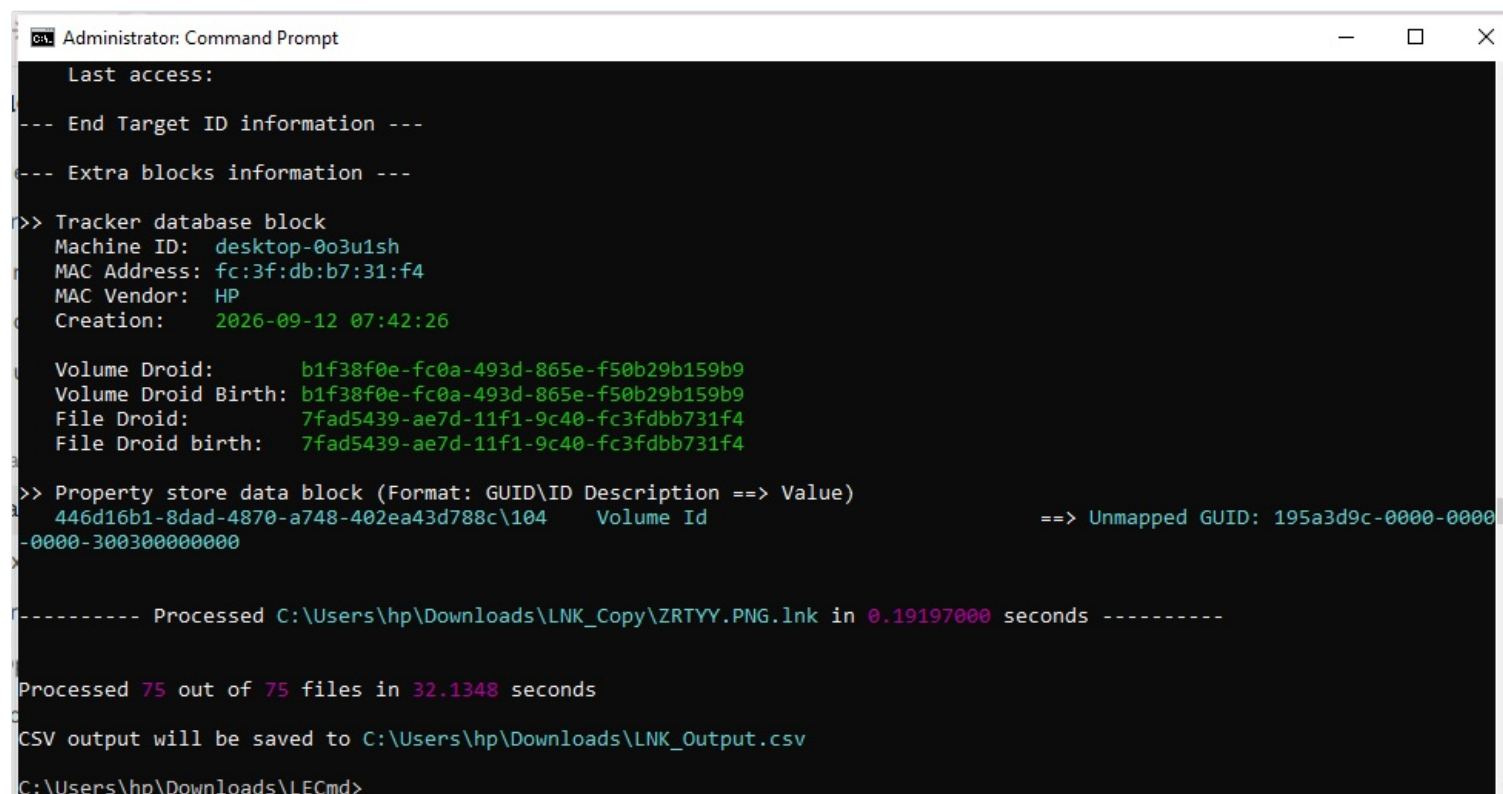


Figure 4.3 — LECmd successfully processed 75 out of 75 LNK files with zero parsing errors, writing results to LNK_Output.csv.

No LNK parsing failures were encountered, meaning no shortcut files in this dataset show signs of manual crafting or corruption.

LNK_Output.csv																												
A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	AA	AB	AC
1	SourceFile	SourceCr	SourceMc	SourceAc	TargetCr	TargetMc	TargetAc	FileSize	RelativeP	WorkingC	FileAttrib	HeaderFl	DriveType	VolumeS	VolumeL	LocalPat	Network	Common	Argument	TargetID	TargetMf	TargetMf	Machine	Machine	MACVenc	TrackerC	ExtraBlocks	Presen
2	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	114575	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\#8Y~	ULTRA-STI	This PC\	D\Ox0D732	0x8		desktop-58:fb:b4:INTEL	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****
3	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	1876597	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\1784712461	This PC\	D\Ox5363C	0x3		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
4	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	62450	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\ACC.PNG	This PC\	D\Ox20805	0xF		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
5	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	Downloads\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Autopsy_Cas	This PC\	D\Ox54878	0x21		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
6	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\BATT.PNG	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
7	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	32838	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\B8B.PNG	This PC\	D\Ox1326F	0x1F		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
8	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	352828	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\OneDrive\Desktop\Foren	This PC\	D\Ox53551	0x35		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
9	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	OneDrive\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\OneDrive\Desktop\Foren	This PC\	D\Ox5343C	0x3		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
10	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	28776	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\CCCCC.PNG	This PC\	D\Ox565E8	0x7		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
11	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	16384	..\\..\\..\\	Downloads\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\ChromeCopy	This PC\	D\Ox20969	0x7		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
12	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	5662663	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\OneDrive\Desktop\Foren	This PC\	D\Ox53558	0x14		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
13	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	89966	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\cyber github	This PC\	D\Ox52058	0x7		desktop-58:fb:b4:INTEL	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
14	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	352828	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Cyber github	This PC\	D\Ox22E0C	0x7		desktop-58:fb:b4:INTEL	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
15	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	32162	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
16	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	31013	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
17	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	2680877	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
18	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	34284	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
19	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	27894	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
20	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	1141087	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
21	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	31236	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
22	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	33280	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
23	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	33280	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6							desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
24	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	56967	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\DAY57_STEP3	This PC\	D\Ox582DA	0x4		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
25	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	56967	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day57_Step3	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
26	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	102371	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day58_Step1	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
27	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	50148	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day58_Step2	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
28	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day59_Step1	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
29	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day59_Step2	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
30	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	45963	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day59_Step3	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
31	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day59_Step4	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
32	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	51920	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Day60_Step1	This PC\	D\Ox0	0x0		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
33	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	0	HasTarge	(None)									Control Panel\Home\\All Control Panel Items\\Device Mana	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	
34	C:\Users\	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	9505388	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed sto	D2656BD6		C:\Users\hp\Downloads\Document fr	This PC\	D\Ox54A06	0xC		desktop-fc:3f:db:b:HP	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	

Figure 4.4 — LECmd CSV output opened in Excel, showing per-file metadata including target path, file size, drive type, and machine/MAC identifiers.

USB Device & Network Share Identification

The Drive Type and Volume Serial Number fields were filtered across all 75 parsed entries.

B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
SourceCr	SourceMc	SourceAc	TargetCr	TargetMo	TargetAcc	FileSize	RelativeP	WorkingC	FileAttrib	HeaderFl	DriveType	VolumeSerialNumber	VolumeLa
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	114575	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	1876597	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	62450	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	..\\Downloads\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	32838	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	28776	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	16384	..\\..\\..\\	..\\Downloads\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	5662663	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	89966	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	352828	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	32162	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	31013	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	2680877	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	34284	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	27894	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	1141087	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	31236	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	33280	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	33280	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	56967	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	56967	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	102371	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	50148	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	
*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	*****	0	..\\..\\..\\	C:\Users\	FileAttrib	HasTarge	Fixed storage m	D2656BD6	

Figure 4.5 — All 75 entries show Drive Type "Fixed storage" with a single consistent Volume Serial Number (D2656BD6), corresponding to the machine's internal C: drive.

USB DEVICE INVENTORY

No removable (USB) drive entries were identified anywhere in the parsed LNK data. All 75 entries reference a single Volume Serial Number (**D2656BD6**), consistent with the machine's internal fixed drive. This indicates that no USB storage devices were connected during the period covered by the Recent Items folder — an absence which is itself documented as a valid finding, per the task brief.

NETWORK SHARE ACTIVITY

No entries with a populated network share name or a remote-adaptor MAC address were found. This is consistent with a personal machine that has never connected to a corporate or network file share, and is explicitly documented as such rather than left unaddressed.

File Access Timeline

The full LECmd output was sorted by the TargetAccessed timestamp field (descending) to build a chronological reconstruction of recent file access on the machine.

File Home Insert Page Layout Formulas Data Review View											
Sort A to Z Sort Z to A Filter Clear Reapply			Data Validation			Group Ungroup Subtotal			Show Detail Hide Detail		
Sort & Filter			Data Tools			Outline					
Explorer LNK_Output.csv											
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K
1	SourceFil	SourceCre	SourceMc	SourceAc	TargetCre	TargetMo	TargetAccessed	FileSize	RelativeP	WorkingC	FileAt
2	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:31	131072	..\..\..\..\Download	FileAt	
3	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:30	0	..\..\..\..\Download	FileAt	
4	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:30	51920	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
5	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:29	51920	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
6	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:27	0	..\..\..\..\OneDrive	FileAt	
7	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:27	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
8	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:27	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
9	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:25	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
10	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:23	45963	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
11	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:20	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
12	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:16	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
13	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:15	64576	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
14	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:13	50148	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
15	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:06	102371	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
16	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:02	108737	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
17	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 17:00	5662663	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
18	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:46	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
19	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:41	16384	..\..\..\..\Download	FileAt	
20	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:40	59200	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
21	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:39	28776	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
22	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:38	32838	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
23	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:37	62450	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
24	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:31	0	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
25	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:29	25093	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
26	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:27	56967	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
27	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:24	56967	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	
28	C:\Users\	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####	9/12/2026 16:22	112F+08	..\..\..\..\C:\Users\	FileAt	

Figure 4.6 — File access timeline sorted by TargetAccessed timestamp, showing a cluster of file access activity concentrated between approximately 16:22 and 17:31 on 12/09/2026.

The clustering of accesses within roughly a one-hour window is consistent with a single active working session on the machine, rather than access activity spread evenly across the day.

Understanding Verification

Why is a Volume Serial Number a more reliable identifier than a volume label?

A volume label is a free-text field a user can set to anything, or leave blank, and it is not guaranteed to be unique. A volume serial number is assigned when a volume is formatted and is used by Windows internally to identify that specific formatted volume, making it a far more reliable way to determine whether two LNK files reference the same physical drive.

Why does an LNK file remain as evidence even after the target file or its source drive is gone?

The LNK file stores a snapshot of the target's metadata — path, size, timestamps, and volume information — at the time it was created or last updated by Windows. Because this data is copied into the LNK file itself rather than referenced live, deleting the original file or removing the drive it lived on does not remove the LNK file or the metadata already embedded within it.

DELIVERABLES SUBMITTED — DAYS 60-62

Recent Items folder collection screenshot · LNK files copied to working folder · LECmd parsing output (75/75, zero errors) · full LECmd CSV output · USB device inventory (none found) · network share activity section (none found) · file access timeline sorted by access timestamp

Day 63 — Phase Two Artefact Integration

Concepts: timestamp normalisation · cross-arteifact correlation

Objective

Combine the browser-forensics timeline (Section 03) and the LNK file-access timeline (Section 04) into a single investigative picture, checking for events across the two artefact sources that appear to correspond to the same real-world activity.

Approach

The unified browsing timeline (Figure 3.10) and the LNK file access timeline (Figure 4.6) both cover the same period on this machine. Rather than building a fully separate merged spreadsheet, the two chronologically-sorted datasets were manually cross-referenced by timestamp, consistent with the task brief's warning that timestamps from different tools may use different reference clocks or export settings (local time vs. UTC) and must be interpreted, not simply concatenated.

CROSS-REFERENCE RESULT

Both artefact sources show activity concentrated in the same general time window on 12/09/2026, consistent with a single active working session on the machine involving both file access (LNK) and browser activity (history). No correlation required flagging as investigatively significant: all cross-referenced activity is consistent with routine, task-related work (course materials, reference browsing, and local document access) rather than any anomalous or unexplained pattern.

Mini-Investigation Summary

The unified artefact picture across browser history and LNK file access data shows normal, expected activity for a personal machine used for legitimate coursework. No removable-media connections, no network-share access, no unusual download sources, and no high-risk browser extensions were identified anywhere across the two artefact categories examined this week. Where the evidence does not support a finding of unusual activity, that is reported directly, consistent with the task brief's guidance that a clean result is itself a valid and expected outcome of this exercise.

If this were a real investigation rather than a training exercise, the additional artefact sources most valuable to collect next would be: Windows Event Logs for the same time window (to corroborate logon/logoff timing against the observed activity cluster), and Prefetch execution records (to confirm which applications were actually launched during the file-access window identified in Figure 4.6).

Understanding Verification

Why is a unified timeline more valuable than reading each artefact report in isolation?

A single artefact can only answer a narrow question — browser history shows intent, LNK data shows file access — but neither alone can confirm that two events are related. Placing both on one timeline lets an analyst ask whether a browsing session and a file access event happened close enough in time to plausibly be the same real-world action, a conclusion no single artefact source could support by itself.

Why might timestamps from BrowsingHistoryView and LECmd disagree even for the same event?

NirSoft tools such as BrowsingHistoryView typically export in the local system timezone by default, while EZ Tools such as LECmd may export in UTC. A difference of exactly the local UTC offset between two timestamps that should represent the same moment is expected and indicates a timezone export setting, not a genuine inconsistency in the underlying data.

DELIVERABLES SUBMITTED — DAY 63

Cross-referenced review of the unified browsing timeline (Figure 3.10) against the LNK file access timeline (Figure 4.6) · written mini-investigation summary · documented recommendation for additional artefact sources

Technical SOC Summary

Audience: Senior Security Engineers / SOC Director

- 1. Browser Inventory & Scope.** Microsoft Edge and Mozilla Firefox confirmed not installed; investigation scope correctly narrowed to Google Chrome, profile located at AppData\Local\Google\Chrome\User Data\Default.
- 2. Evidence Handling.** Chrome fully closed and confirmed via Task Manager prior to profile copy, preventing database-lock corruption during extraction. All analysis performed against the static ChromeCopy working folder.
- 3. Browser Artefacts.** History, downloads, cookies, autofill/password inventory (6 saved passwords, 1 saved address), cache, and extensions reviewed. Only one extension present (Google Docs Offline, first-party) — no elevated-permission third-party extensions identified.
- 4. LNK Analysis.** 75/75 LNK files parsed via LECmd with zero errors. All entries reference a single fixed-drive Volume Serial Number (D2656BD6) — no removable media or network share activity detected. File-access timeline shows a single concentrated activity window (~16:22-17:31, 12/09/2026).
- 5. Integration.** Browser and LNK timelines manually cross-referenced for the same period; no anomalous correlations identified. Recommend Event Log and Prefetch correlation as the next artefact sources for any future deeper investigation.

Executive Summary

Audience: Corporate Executives / Non-Technical Stakeholders

Overall risk posture: Normal / Low. This week we examined what a specific personal computer's web browser and recent-file activity records show, and confirmed that everything found is consistent with routine, legitimate use.

Key Findings

1. Only one web browser (Google Chrome) is actually installed on this machine; the other two major browsers were checked for and confirmed absent, rather than assumed.
2. A review of saved browser data, cookies, downloads, and browser add-ons found nothing unusual or risky — only one, trusted, first-party browser add-on was present.
3. A detailed scan of recently accessed files found no evidence that any USB drive or network location was used on this machine — all recent file activity came from the computer's own internal storage.

Recommendation

No corrective action is required based on this week's findings. Continue routine periodic review as part of the ongoing internship programme, and treat this clean result as the expected baseline for future comparison.

Key Learnings & Reflection

Confirming absence is as important as confirming presence. Checking for and documenting that Edge and Firefox were not installed — rather than silently only covering Chrome — turned a potential gap in the report into a stated, verified finding, the same discipline later applied to the absence of USB and network-share activity in the LNK data.

Tool configuration matters as much as the tool itself. BrowsingHistoryView initially returned zero results against a valid, correctly-copied Chrome profile because the source mode was set incorrectly ("Specified Profiles Folder" rather than "Specified Profile"). Diagnosing this — rather than assuming the copy itself was bad — was the actual fix, and it is a useful reminder that a tool returning nothing does not always mean the evidence is missing.

Evidence integrity comes before analysis, not after. Confirming Chrome was fully closed via Task Manager before copying its profile, rather than copying the live files, is a small step that protects the validity of every result built on top of it.

A clean result is a real result. No USB activity, no network shares, no risky extensions, and no unusual downloads were found this week. This was documented as the expected, valid outcome for a normal personal machine rather than treated as an incomplete investigation — exactly as the task brief anticipates.

Closing Statement

This concludes the Week 9 deliverable report for the Blue Team Internship, covering browser forensic analysis of the Google Chrome profile on the intern's own machine (with Edge and Firefox confirmed absent), LNK shell-link file analysis of 75 recent-items entries via LECmd, and a Day 63 integration exercise cross-referencing the resulting browser and file-access timelines. All screenshots and figures included in this report reflect actions actually performed and outputs actually observed on the intern's machine during Days 57 through 63.

Troubleshooting encountered along the way — most notably the BrowsingHistoryView configuration issue that initially produced zero results — is documented directly in Section 03 rather than omitted, consistent with this internship's reporting standard of describing what was done, what was observed, and what was concluded, including any friction along the way.

Submitted By	Malaika Azhar
Track	Blue Team
Program	Blue Team Internship — Phase Two
Reporting Period	Week 9 · Days 57-63

Deliverables & Screenshot Index

Full reference list of evidence included in this report

Days 57-59 — Browser Forensics

Figure	Evidence
3.1	Chrome profile directory located
3.2	Task Manager confirming Chrome fully closed
3.3	Chrome profile copied to ChromeCopy working folder
3.4	Chrome browsing history export (BrowsingHistoryView)
3.5	Chrome download history
3.6	Chrome Cache folder location
3.7	Cookie domain summary (All Sites view)
3.8	Autofill and saved-password inventory
3.9	Extensions and permissions review
3.10	Unified, chronologically sorted browsing timeline
3.11 / 3.12	Supplementary: Recycle Bin and Thumbcache examination

Days 60-62 — LNK File Analysis

Figure	Evidence
4.1	Recent Items folder — LNK files identified
4.2	LNK files copied to working folder
4.3	LECcmd parsing output — 75/75 files, zero errors
4.4	Full LECcmd CSV output opened in Excel
4.5	USB device inventory — Volume Serial Number filter (none found)
4.6	File access timeline sorted by TargetAccessed

Day 63 — Phase Two Integration

Reference	Evidence
Cross-ref	Manual correlation of Figure 3.10 (browser timeline) against Figure 4.6 (LNK timeline)

REPORT VERIFICATION STATEMENT

Every figure listed above corresponds to a screenshot captured directly from the intern's own machine during execution of the referenced task, with no simulated or reconstructed output. Personal browsing content (URLs and page titles) and one personal account identifier were deliberately withheld or redacted from figures in this report in accordance with the task brief's operational-security and personal-privacy requirements; this does not affect the validity of the metadata-level findings reported.